Flower, Zimbabwe's best batsman. Now we needed to carry this form forward, as we would soon be playing England in what was likely to be a crucial match for us, one that could guarantee a place in the Super Six.

Before the England match, however, we had to play Namibia on 23 February and it was important not to take it easy against a relatively weak team. We kept the pressure up and scored 311–2, with Sourav and me both scoring hundreds. Our bowlers then dismissed the opposition for 130, with Yuvraj Singh taking four wickets for six runs, and though not much could be read into our performance against a team like Namibia, it was apparent that things were moving in the right direction.

The build-up to the England game at Durban on 26 February was something else. England versus India is always a big game, but this time it was the World Cup and it was a must-win game for both teams. Apparently Andrew Caddick said a number of things before the game and our players who read those statements were fired up on the eve of the match. I had not read them and to this day don't know exactly what was said. I had scored runs in all three matches so far and was simply looking forward to another opportunity.

We won a very important toss and decided to bat first. Batting under lights at Durban is always a challenge and winning the toss had given us the early advantage. Our plan was not to give away early wickets, even if we didn't score quickly. Once the first five or six overs had gone by we started shifting gear and looking for runs, passing 50 in no time. Durban always offers something for the fast bowlers and I knew that Caddick and the other tall England bowlers would look to exploit the extra bounce by bowling short of a length. I was ready for the short ball and it finally came in the ninth over of the innings when Caddick bowled one a foot and a half outside the off stump. It was exactly what I was waiting for and I swivelled back and hit him over midwicket for six. The moment the ball hit my bat I knew it was going the distance.

In his next over I played one of my favourite shots of the World Cup. I was hoping Caddick would over-compensate and bowl a fuller delivery, which he did. It wasn't a bad ball but I managed to play an off drive on the up, bisecting mid off and the bowler for four. The timing and impact felt wonderful. I hit two more boundaries in the same over and we raced to 75 off just eleven overs.

It was a dream start in a very big game and it took a great spell from Andrew Flintoff to bring England back into the match. He conceded just